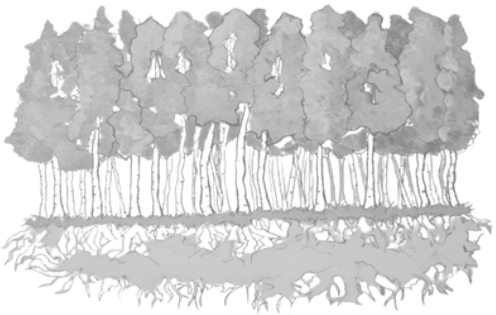
Empower



PERSERVERING IN FELLOWSHIP

And let us consider how we may spur one another on toward love and good deeds, not giving up meeting together, as some are in the habit of doing, but encouraging one another—and all the more as you see the Day approaching.
Hebrews 10:24-25

Aspen trees are unique in that they have roots that are connected together to unite the trees into one organism. So it is meant to be in the body of Christ -- we are designed to be interconnected to others in the body, united under the headship of Christ. As we journey through life, our primary source of fellowship may shift. In life, we may find belonging in places like friends, our church body, family, and/or marriage. In each of us is the danger towards extremes, either of isolation or co-dependence. Which extreme do you find it easiest to gravitate towards and why?

Spend time considering the verses below that describe how we are to relate to "one another."

- John 13:34-35
- Romans 12:10
- Romans 15:7
- 1 Peter 4:9
- Romans 12:16
- Ephesians 4:32
- Ephesians 4:2-3

We all desire to be fully known and fully loved. To be loved but not known is comforting, but superficial. To be known and not loved is our greatest fear. Consider the quote below by pastor Tim Keller. What stands out to you?

...to be fully known and truly loved is, well, a lot like being loved by God. It is what we need more than anything. It liberates us from pretense, humbles us out of our self-righteousness, and fortifies us for any difficulty life can throw at us

Consider the principles below and what the Bible teaches us about community. What principle impacts you the most?

1. Mankind was not meant to be alone (Gen 2:18)
2. Mankind has always feared isolation (Gen 4:13)
3. Mankind has always pursued community (Gen 11:2)
4. Mankind has always been tempted to replace God with community (Gen 11:4)

Consider the four practical principles below. What application would you like to make moving forward in life as you persevere in fellowship with others?

- Intentionality – quality is not dictated by frequency.
- Consistency – patience & repetition wins hearts.
- Vulnerability – model the depth of relationship you want.
- Consolidating – make the most of existing circumstances around you.

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